

Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree and a year in the Metrolinx Service Design office, where the work was rail network simulation and modelling in OpenTrack. Currently an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto. Builds the simulation and analysis that turns proposed service and infrastructure changes into defensible operating requirements.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Analyze travel and network data to establish where capacity falls short and what that means for future service and investment.
- Review development applications and engineering studies for their effect on existing and planned infrastructure, and recommend conditions where capacity is at risk.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, combining several years of data from separate operational sources into one validated source the division reports from.
- Run assigned studies from scoping through to recommendations, and write the technical reports and briefing notes that carry them to planners, engineers and managers across divisions.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services, building and testing network scenarios against infrastructure constraints, speed restrictions and corridor conditions.
- Established what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, schedule reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Assessed the network effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, including how far a speed restriction carried beyond the subdivision it sat on.
- Analysed run-time and speed profile patterns across subdivisions to find where schedules were most exposed to variance, working from the operations data directly where the volumes ruled out doing it by hand.
- Worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers to pin down the technical and operational variables a service plan had to be built on.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

OpenTrack rail simulation and network modelling. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL and JavaScript. Operations data handling, pipelines and validation. VISSIM, Synchro and MATSim. ArcGIS and QGIS. Technical reporting and performance dashboards. MS Office, including large multi-source Excel workbooks.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)